



BSc (Hons) in **Information Technology**
Specialized in AI

IT3012 : Intelligent Agents

Year 3 · Semester 1 · 2026 Semester 2

Faculty of Computing

Practical 01

Objective & Lecture Mapping: Recall that an intelligent agent acts within a continuous loop: Sensors generate percept sequences, and Actuators execute actions to maximize a Performance measure. Use this sheet to execute practical modifications and incrementally evaluate your design against Lecture 01 and 02 theory (from basic recall to analytical classification).

Part 1: Code Analysis & PEAS Evaluation

Task 0 : Setting up and getting the starter Code

1. Go to the [Git Hub Repo](#). Create a Fork of this Git Repo to your Personal Github Profile. Open it using your favourite IDE and follow the below instruction to complete the practical. The base code is in the "master" brach of the repo.

Task 1.1: The Environment State (`__init__`)

1. (Remember) List the four components of the PEAS framework discussed in Lecture 01.

Performance Measure
Environment
Actuators
Sensors

2. (Understand) Look at the `VisualGridHuntGame.__init__` method. Which specific variables in this code represent the physical "Environment (E)" state?

```
self.width
self.height
self.walls
self.food_positions
self.toxic_traps
self.opponents
self.agent_pos
```

3. (Analyze) Based on the variables initialized (specifically `self.opponents`), classify this baseline environment as "Single-Agent" or "Multi-Agent". Briefly justify your choice.

This is a Multi-Agent environment because it contains `self.opponents`, which represent other agents that move independently and can interact with the main agent by causing collisions

Task 1.2: The Perception Subsystem (`get_percept`)

4. (Remember) Define what a "percept sequence" is according to Lecture 01.

A percept sequence is the complete history of all percepts (observations) that an agent receives from the environment over time.

5. (Understand) Which component of the PEAS framework does the `get_percept()` method represent in our code?

`get_percept()` represents the Sensors component because it gathers information from the environment and provides it to the agent.

6. (Evaluate) Based on the exact dictionary returned by `get_percept()` , is this environment "Fully Observable" or "Partially Observable"? Explain why based on what the agent can and cannot see.

This environment is Fully Observable because `get_percept()` returns the agent's position, opponent positions, collision status, score, remaining food, and other relevant information, allowing the agent to observe the current environment state.

Task 1.3: Action Execution (execute_action)

7. (Understand) When `execute_action()` deducts points for hitting a wall, which PEAS component is being actively updated?

The Performance Measure is updated because the score changes according to the agent's actions.

8. (Evaluate) Why is it structurally important that this metric evaluates changes in the external environment state (hitting a wall) rather than the agent's internal processing effort?

The performance measure should evaluate the results of the agent's actions in the environment, such as collecting food or avoiding walls, because these determine whether the agent achieves its goal. Internal processing does not directly measure success in the environment.

Part 2: Guided Modification & Deep Theory Mapping

Follow the implementation instructions to inject a new hazard, then answer the questions to map your code changes back to the theoretical nature of the environment.

Step 2.1: Extending the Environment Initialization (`__init__`)

1. **Implementation Instructions:** Declare a new trap collection attribute (e.g., `self.toxic_traps = set()`) inside `__init__`. Populate it with coordinate tuples safely avoiding position `(0, 0)`, walls, and food.

9. (Understand) If you successfully add `self.toxic_traps` to the environment but intentionally **hide** this data from the agent's sensors, how does this specifically alter the environment's "Observability" classification?

The environment becomes Partially Observable because the traps exist in the environment, but the agent cannot directly perceive their locations through its sensors.

Step 2.2: Updating the Perception Subsystem (get_percept)

1. **Implementation Instructions:** Locate `get_percept(self)` and add a new boolean sensor key (e.g., `'smells_toxin': tuple(self.agent_pos)` in `self.toxic_traps`) to the dictionary returned to the agent loop.
10. (Analyze) By adding `'smells_toxin'` , you expand the agent's percept sequence. Explain how this specific sensor helps the agent act with "Rationality" (maximizing expected utility).

The `smells_toxin` sensor provides additional information about the environment, allowing the agent to detect toxic traps and avoid them. This helps the agent make better decisions and maximize its performance score.

Step 2.3: Modifying Action Execution & Visual Rendering (execute_action & draw_grid)

1. **Implementation Instructions:** In `execute_action` , check if the updated `self.agent_pos` intersects with `self.toxic_traps` to decrement `self.score` by 15 points. In `draw_grid` , iterate through traps to render custom purple shapes on the canvas.
11. (Remember) You programmed a severe score penalty for stepping on a trap to avoid metric exploitation. What was the classic "Vacuum World Exploit" example discussed in Lecture 01 that illustrated the danger of faulty metrics?

The classic Vacuum World exploit is when an agent repeatedly creates dirt and then cleans it to gain continuous rewards. This demonstrates that a poorly designed performance measure can be exploited instead of encouraging the intended goal of keeping the environment clean.

Finalize and Lock Lab 01 Analytical Evaluation



FACULTY OF COMPUTING